

Ever Thought of Starting A Venture of Your Own?

How would it be if you developed your own technology, created your own business network and started your own firm? Many engineers have a 'big idea' but there is always some kind of uncertainty to it. We got in touch with three industry experts and a beginner in this field, and spoke to them about how engineering graduates, especially electronics engineers, can start their own firms... how they could go about it, the pitfalls they might face and the big question—is it worth the effort?



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Looking for a job today, that too in one of the core industries, in the current environment seems like an uphill task. Even among those who have a job, there will be a handful who would like to start off something of their own. This article discusses the options that are open to fresh engineering graduates, and to those who are skilled but want to quit their current jobs to start a venture of their own. The article focuses on the field of electronics with respect to manufacturing, assembly and repairs.

Can an engineer be an entrepreneur?

At a time when finding an occupation is hard, the sensible option (which is actu-

ally being pursued by many) after graduation would be to either study further or start your own business, which can be one of the hardest, most challenging and demanding options. Besides, success in business is hardly ever guaranteed. Having said that, it can also be one of the most rewarding endeavours, both financially and professionally.

According to a survey, people with engineering qualifications are more likely to run a business than those with an MBA. Engineers with the right mix of a technical background and entrepreneurial abilities have a good chance of starting projects of their own. With job uncertainty increasing by the day, entrepreneurship is now a good option to consider. So, the question is: Can an engineer be a successful entrepreneur?

Yes, believes Vinay Chaddha, CTO, GVC Systems Pvt Ltd. He says, "All a person needs is guts; everything else will fall in place. But I assume that readers would be interested in starting a micro-sized or a small enterprise, rather than starting a large-scale organisation, for which they need to be financially sound."

Ganesh Shankar, managing director of FluxGen Engineering Technologies, which is a start-up, says, "In my opinion, engineers with a business idea should ideally ask themselves the following questions: 'Why do I want to start a business?', 'Who will be my immediate customers?', 'Who will be my end customers?' and, 'What are my skill sets—do I have, at least, the basic skills to start working towards the business?' If the motivation is strong, the rest will most likely fall in place."

The first step

Sharing his views on the important first step in starting a business, Vinay Chaddha says, "They should know their skills really well. The most critical thing in the field of entrepreneurship is to understand your own skills and, more importantly, whether people will be willing to pay for your skills or not. Personally, I have been through all the stages—repairing, designing and manufacturing. If aspiring entrepreneurs can understand their strengths, whether in the field of manufacturing, repairing or designing, they should go for it."

The first step is generally the toughest of all, and it can be exceed-